

Technical Note: *Rūpa*, *Guṇa*, *Svabhāva*, and *Dharma* in a State-Dynamic Unit

Author: AnalyticMadhyasthDarshan.org — a group of people studying Madhyasth Darshan philosophy.

Edited on: August 21, 2026, 3:25 PM IST

Status: Internal technical note; not a catalog entry and not part of the released text of *The Ontology of Coexistence*.

Scope: This note clarifies the four inseparable aspects attributed to every unit (*ikai*) in Madhyasth Darshan: form (*rūpa*), property or relative power (*guṇa*), essential nature (*svabhāva*), and *dharma*. Its central question is whether a unit can consistently be understood as a process or activity at the fundamental level. The same four aspects are then asked of a compound or further organisation as a containing unit, without collapsing the constituents into that whole. They are also assembled as one process-dynamic: present configuration, order-typed potential, and coupled motion. *Nyāya*, *dharma*, and *satya* name universal truths of that dynamic: followed by default, with no option, in insentient (*jada*) units, and followed through understanding where sentience has option. The process-language below is an analytical reconstruction of the primary texts, not a claim that those texts explicitly adopt a modern school of process philosophy.

1. The interpretive problem

The four terms can initially look like a list of attributes attached to an otherwise passive thing. That reading becomes difficult once the same texts describe nature as countless activities, place effort, motion, and result inseparably in every activity, and state that force belongs to state while power belongs to motion. A purely static interpretation of the unit therefore misses the texts' insistence on continuous activeness. Yet a pure process interpretation can also mislead if it dissolves the unit into events or relations, because the unit remains a definite, bounded bearer with constitution, continuity, and its own "ness."

The more adequate interpretation is that a unit is a **bounded, state-dynamic activity-whole**. "State-dynamic" preserves the inseparability of state and motion; "activity-whole" preserves the unit as an identifiable bearer rather than a passing event. The four terms then name four irreducible aspects of this one active whole, not four separable components and not four successive stages.

Every unit is a bounded, state-dynamic activity-whole. As determinate configuration it is rūpa; as power in motion and mutual influence it is guṇa; as order-specific characteristic conduct it is svabhāva; and as the innateness it bears it is dharma.

When the unit is itself a compound or a further organisation, the same four aspects apply twice: once to the constituents, once to the containing unit (§8).

2. Four questions asked of one unit

Aspect	Question answered	Primary-text emphasis	Process-compatible reading
Form (<i>rūpa</i>)	What determinate configuration is present?	Shape, volume, density, boundary-framework and reflected image	The bounded configuration to which result is connected; not an effect in the same sense as <i>guṇa</i>
Property (<i>guṇa</i>)	How does the unit's power operate?	Relative power; generative, degenerative, or mediative motion and effect in mutuality	The unit's operative power in motion and its definite influence when units come together
Essential nature (<i>svabhāva</i>)	What characteristic conduct or functional significance does that operation express?	Essentiality; usefulness of properties; conduct through which essentiality is expressed	The recurring, order-specific functional character displayed through the unit's powers
<i>Dharma</i>	What innateness does the unit bear according to its order?	<i>Dhāraṇā</i> or innateness; existence, growth, hope to live, and happiness, cumulatively across the four orders	The order-specific innateness borne on the effort/force side; in the knowledge order its evidence and evaluation is happiness and resolution

The table is analytical rather than sequential. A unit does not first acquire form, then activate property, then develop essential nature, and finally reach *dharma*. The four are simultaneous aspects of the same unit. Nor does “fundamental aspect” mean ontological independence: *svabhāva* depends on powers for its expression, but it cannot be reduced to a list of powers; *dharma* is evidenced through conduct, but it cannot be reduced to one episode of conduct.

3. The process basis: state, motion, and result

Madhyasth Darshan treats the unit as both a state and a motion. Force (*bal*) is identified on the side of state, power (*śakti*) on the side of motion, while state and motion remain inseparable. Every activity is correspondingly presented as the inseparable presence of effort, motion, and result (*śram–gati–pariṇām*). These are not three chronological moments. Effort names the active tendency already present, motion its dynamic expression, and result the determinate condition being attained or maintained (SB, pp. 58–62, 248–252).

One passage relates this triad directly to the four aspects: effort or force is present as *dharma* and *svabhāva*; motion as *svabhāva* and *guṇa*; and result as *rūpa* and immortality (*amaratva*). This does not establish a one-to-one derivation, because *svabhāva* crosses both effort and motion. It does, however, make a static bundle-of-properties reading implausible. Form is connected to determinate result, property to motion, essential nature to the characteristic continuity of effort in motion, and *dharma* to

the innateness borne as force or effort. Immortality of result is the goal of constitutional completeness for the sentient atom; it is not a claim that every present shape is indestructible (SB, pp. 60–62).

The resulting process-picture is therefore:

Activity-side	Ontological expression
Effort or force	Present as <i>dharma</i> and <i>svabhāva</i> : the innateness borne, and the essential nature through which force appears as conduct
Motion or power	Present as <i>svabhāva</i> and <i>guṇa</i> : the operative influence of power, characterised as essential nature
Result	Present as <i>rūpa</i> and immortality (<i>amaratva</i>): determinate configuration, oriented toward non-decomposable result at constitutional completeness

The same alignment is written as one process-dynamic of the unit in §9.

4. Why *rūpa* is not an absolute effect

Form and property must not be separated as “absolute effect” and “relative effect.” *Rūpa* is not an effect in the same sense as *guṇa*. It is the real configuration by which the unit is bounded and individuated: shape, volume, and density. Its motion-path and constitution provide a framework within which the unit remains one definite unit. A developing atom can change in form as its constitution changes, so form is neither an immaterial essence nor an eternally immutable shape (MVD, pp. 42, 50–51; SB, pp. 55, 249–250).

Form is nevertheless relationally encountered. In mutual facing, the unit’s form is reflected or imaged to another unit, and its dimensions are measured only in comparison with another measure. Reflection does not create the form; it is the manner in which an already bounded unit becomes present across mutuality. The distinction is consequently between **unit-grounded configuration** and **relationally operative power**, not between absolute and relative effects.

The word “absolute” is especially unsuitable here because the texts reserve absolute truth for coexistence as nature saturated in *satta*. Form, properties, essential nature, and *dharma* together belong to the objective truth of units. A useful formulation is therefore:

Rūpa is objectively unit-grounded but relationally encountered; guṇa is unit-grounded as power and relationally actualised as effect.

5. *Guṇa*: relative power rather than a static quality

The primary definition calls *guṇa* relative power (*sāpekṣa śakti*) and also the effect that arises when more than one entity comes together. A later analysis identifies the force-bearing unit as *guṇī* and its power as *guṇa*: the bearer and the property are inseparable, while the property’s operation is evident as

motion, influence, and field of influence (MVD, p. 47; SB, pp. 248–252, 256–257). That meeting of entities is still a relative-power fact. It is not, by itself, the appearance of a new bounded unit. Mixture and compound are distinguished in §8.

The three modes specify the direction of that operation:

Mode of <i>guṇa</i>	Definition	Direction of effect
<i>Sam</i>	Power assisting <i>srjan</i>	Generative, formative, or developmental
<i>Viṣam</i>	Power assisting <i>visarjan</i>	Degenerative, dissolutive, or declining
<i>Madhyastha</i>	Power assisting <i>vibhava</i>	Mediative, sustaining, balancing, and conserving

“Regenerative” is narrower than *sam*, because *srjan* need not restore a former state; “generative” is the safer general rendering. *Viṣam* is dissolutive rather than generative. *Madhyastha* does not mean inactivity or an average between two extremes. It names active regulation by which generative and degenerative movements remain balanced and a definite organisation is sustained (MVD, pp. 26, 50–51).

These modes are not moral categories. Formation and dissolution both participate in material and biological cycles. The triad names the directional character of power before any specifically biological, animal, or human evaluation of that power has been made.

6. *Svabhāva*: essentiality and the usefulness of properties

The primary text places two definitions together: essentiality or fundamental character (*maulikata*) is *svabhāva*, and the usefulness (*upayogitā*) of properties is *svabhāva* (MVD, p. 47). “Usefulness” cannot mean merely beneficial, agreeable, or useful to a human observer, because the same text includes devitalising and cruel essential natures. The term is better read here as **functional significance, operative relevance, or the kind of conduct in which the unit’s powers become meaningful within an order**.

This explains why *svabhāva* is not merely another classification of *guṇa*. The generic classification of property remains *sam–viṣam–madhyastha* across all four orders, whereas the classification of essential nature changes with the order:

Order	Generic power-modes (<i>guṇa</i>)	Order-specific essential nature (<i>svabhāva</i>)
Material	Generative, degenerative, mediative	Integration–disintegration and their continuity
Biological or pranic	Generative, degenerative, mediative	Vitalising–devitalising
Animal	Generative, degenerative, mediative	Cruel–uncruel

Order	Generic power-modes (<i>guṇa</i>)	Order-specific essential nature (<i>svabhāva</i>)
Knowledge or human	Generative, degenerative, mediative	Fortitude, courage, generosity, kindness, grace, and compassion

The knowledge-order cell records that order's defining essential nature, not a paired opposite-set of the kind *cruel–uncruel* is for the animal order. Unawakened human essential nature is named separately as servility, perfidy, and cruelty (MVD, p. 58). In the progression of awakening it appears as that inhumane triad before awakening, as fortitude, courage, and generosity with awakening, and as kindness, grace, and compassion in the completeness of awakening (SB, p. 180). Those are states of the human unit, not a second definition of knowledge-order *svabhāva*.

At the material level the distinction between *guṇa* and *svabhāva* is thin: generative–degenerative motion and integration–disintegration conduct closely track one another. It becomes clearer in the higher orders. Generative activity alone does not tell whether a biological composition nourishes or debilitates a body, whether animal conduct causes or avoids suffering, or whether a human unit is in the inhumane or the awakened appearance of essential nature. Those are further, order-specific determinations of what the powers amount to in conduct.

The texts therefore describe conduct as the activity through which essentiality is expressed and identify conduct itself with *svabhāva* (MVD, p. 77). Essential nature is unit-grounded as fundamental character but relation-disclosed in its expression. Recognition does not create it. A plant's vitalising or devitalising character, an animal's friendliness or opposition, and a human's generosity or cruelty become evident only in definite mutualities, yet they are not arbitrary projections by an observer.

7. *Dharma*: the innateness borne by an order

The primary definition, *dhāraṇā hi dharma*, presents *dharma* as what is innately borne or maintained. In this technical use it does not initially mean religious affiliation, a statutory command, or an externally imposed moral duty. It names the order-specific innateness of the unit, mapped on the effort/force side of the triad rather than as a later effect of *guṇa* (MVD, p. 47; SB, pp. 60–61).

The texts state the order-specific *dharma*s cumulatively:

Order	<i>Dharma</i>
Material	Existence
Biological or pranic	Existence and growth
Animal	Existence, growth, and hope to live
Knowledge or human	Existence, growth, hope to live, and happiness

The higher order does not lose the *dharma* of the lower. A biological unit remains existent while evidencing growth; an animal joint form evidences both and additionally the hope to live; the knowledge order bears the further possibility and requirement of happiness. The order-table must be read with the body/*jeevan* split: existence and growth are evident in the body, whereas hope to live is observed only in *jeevan*; existence and growth are evident in the human body, while *sanskar* and happiness must be realised in *jeevan* for that *dharma* to be meaningful (SB, pp. 179–180; MVD, pp. 50–51, 115). The table does not imply that every composite organisation is indestructible. Existence belongs to the realities participating in composition, while particular compositions can form and disintegrate. How the four aspects then sit on both the constituents and the containing unit is taken up in §8.

Dharma is therefore not simply the long-term effect of *guṇa*, nor a synonym for whatever continuity a present form happens to maintain. It names what the unit innately bears. Conduct can accord with that innateness or fail it. In the knowledge order the further *dharma* is happiness, and its evaluation in mutuality is resolution. Fulfilment in that human sense is the evidence of innateness, not a second generic definition of *dharma*.

8. Compound, mixture, and a containing unit's four aspects

The four aspects were stated for a generic unit. Composition raises a further question: when several units come together, does one tetrad cover both the parts and the whole, or must the same four questions be asked twice?

Mixture (*mishran*) and compound (*yaugik*) are distinguished by conduct, not by mere proximity. In a mixture the participating units keep their respective conducts. In a compound they combine in definite proportion, give up exhibiting those respective conducts as the public motion of the whole, and exhibit a new kind of conduct (MVD, p. 42). That new conduct is the containing unit's own form, property, essential nature, and *dharma*. The constituents nevertheless remain of their order: whatever a thing is constituted of, it remains equal to that basic entity; soil in a pot stays soil, and pranic cells in a body stay of the pranic order (SB, p. 260). Composition is not development: a new compound may close a new bounded conduct while the atomic progression toward constitutional completeness remains a distinct line (SB, pp. 75–76).

The reconstruction therefore assigns **two tetrads**, not one fused list. The texts state the new-versus-retained conduct distinction and the order-of-constituent claim; they do not write “two tetrads.” The two-tetrad assignment is this note's way of keeping those two facts together.

Aspect	Constituents	Containing compound as a unit
Form (<i>rūpa</i>)	Own shape, volume, density, and boundary	New bounded configuration of the whole
Property (<i>guṇa</i>)	Relative powers continue under the organisation	Public effect of the whole as one relative power, not a sum of the constituents' effects

Aspect	Constituents	Containing compound as a unit
Essential nature (<i>svabhāva</i>)	Order-specific conduct of each part remains	The compound's own essentiality as that new conduct
<i>Dharma</i>	Existence, and the innateness of each constituent's own order	The compound's own innateness as that organisation; disintegration ends the organisation, not the existence of the constituents

A mixture has no such containing unit. Results can still flow: collision and mixture can produce mutual *guṇa*-effect without a new bearer. The definition of *guṇa* as the effect that arises when more than one entity comes together (§5) therefore covers interaction as such; it does not by itself decide whether a new unit has appeared.

The same two-tetrad pattern continues where organisation is biological rather than physicochemical. A cell and a body are further containing units: each has its own bounded form, public relative power, order-specific conduct, and innateness, while the cells of a body remain of the pranic order. Those organisations are not themselves *yaugik* in the atomic or molecular sense. Sentience of an animal or human joint form belongs to the *jeevan* joined with the body, not to the composition of cells. Composing *jeevan* yields an organised assembly of *jeevan*, never a larger *jeevan*. Human families and social assemblies are not compounds in the physicochemical sense; their continuity is achieved through relationship-fulfilment rather than chemically definite proportion (*The Ontology of Coexistence*, §1.10; *A State-Dynamic Model of Coexistence*, §5.4).

9. Process dynamics of the unit

The four aspects and the triad can be read together as one process-picture of how a unit continues. Configuration, innateness, relative power, and characteristic conduct then occupy definite roles in the same activity-whole, rather than remaining a list beside a separate set of equations.

9.1 Present configuration as *rūpa*

Each unit is presently a bounded configuration: shape, volume, density, and the motion-path that keeps it one definite bearer. That present state is *rūpa*. In the reconstruction it is the state vector $x(t)$: the result (*pariṇām*) already attained or being maintained, not an effect in the same sense as *guṇa*. The unit is never a bare point that later acquires form. Form is the configuration from which activity is read.

9.2 Order-typed potential as *dharma*

The unit does not drift in an empty field. It bears an order-specific innateness — existence, and in the higher orders growth, hope to live, and happiness — and that innateness orients its activity. *Dharma* is that orientation, mapped on the effort/force side. In the reconstruction it is the potential Φ .

“Cumulative” here is the order-table of §7: a higher-order unit bears the lower *dharma*s as well. It is not a global potential formed by adding every unit's *dharma*. Each bearer has its own Φ typed by its

order. A containing unit's Φ_c is not the sum of the constituents' Φ_i (§8). Saturation in *satta* is the common condition of existence for every unit; *satta* remains actionless, and is not a potential that units fall down.

The “overall” setup in which a unit moves is therefore the coupled field of the units it actually meets, together with its own Φ , and together with a containing unit's organisation when one is present. Property is relative power; the neighbourhood N is those mutual facings, not a mean field over all of nature.

9.3 Motion as *guṇa* and *svabhāva*

Motion (*gati*) is the unit's activity as change of that present configuration. The reconstruction writes

$$\dot{x}(t) = F(x(t), x_N; \Phi)$$

State and motion are locked at every duration. The unit does not first occupy a form, then consult a potential, then begin to move. Effort, motion, and result remain a joint form.

Guṇa names the directional modes of that motion as relative power in mutuality: generative, degenerative, or mediative. *Svabhāva* names the order-specific character of the same motion: integration–disintegration in matter, vitalising–devitalising in the pranic order, cruel–uncruel in the animal order, humane or inhumane in the knowledge order. The two are not two successive reactions. They are two aspects of one F : how the power operates, and what characteristic conduct that operation expresses. Neighbours enter F because *guṇa* is the effect that arises when units come together; *svabhāva* is recognised in that same mutuality.

Dynamical role	Aspect	Reconstruction
Present bounded state	Form (<i>rūpa</i>)	$x(t)$
Order-typed innateness orienting activity	<i>Dharma</i>	Φ , cumulative across orders in that unit, not a sum across units
Directional relative power	Property (<i>guṇa</i>)	Modes of F : <i>sam</i> , <i>viṣam</i> , <i>madhyastha</i>
Order-specific character of that power	Essential nature (<i>svabhāva</i>)	Qualitative character of F
Instantaneous activity as a joint form	Effort–motion–result	$\dot{x} = F(x, x_N; \Phi)$

9.4 Why motion is not a second rate of change

A Newtonian reading would take *rūpa* as position, Φ as a scalar potential V , and motion as the acceleration produced by that potential: $\ddot{x} = -\nabla V$. That reading captures one intended insight — the unit's activity is a response to innateness in a field of other units, not an arbitrary velocity. It does not match the triad.

Force (*bal*) is identified with state, and power (*śakti*) with motion. Effort, motion, and result are simultaneous, each a joint form of the other two. A second-order equation would give velocity an independent inertia and identify force with the change of motion. The reconstruction therefore keeps first-order locking: $\dot{x}$ is determined together with x and Φ . Gradient-flow language — motion as the immediate reaction of the present configuration to the potential — can illustrate that orientation. Inertial second-order language cannot be read back as a fifth aspect, and it is not a second definition of *guṇa* or *svabhāva* (SB, pp. 58–62, 248–252).

9.5 Relatively stable kinds

Units occupy relatively stable kinds of closed conduct while complementary couplings hold. Those kinds are not idle points at which $\dot{x}$ vanishes. The closed form remains recognisable; activity continues. The state-dynamic model writes them as nested plateaus of X . The kinds named in the texts, under conducive conditions on this earth, include constitution-oriented atoms, molecules, compounds and minerals, pranic cells, plant bodies, animal and human bodies, constitutionally complete *jeevan*, and the animal and human joint forms (*A State-Dynamic Model of Coexistence*, §4.3).

Those kinds are not one ladder that a single $x(t)$ climbs. Composition closes a new bounded unit; development in the atom reaches constitutional completeness. A plant body is a pranic composition, not *jeevan*. Animal and human beings are joint forms: the compositional line supplies that order's body, the atomic line supplies *jeevan*. *Jeevan* is not produced by composing cells, and composing *jeevan* never yields a larger *jeevan*. Families and assemblies are not physicochemical compounds (§8). How *nyāya*, *dharma*, and *satya* sit in that dynamic — by default in *jada*, through understanding where there is option — is taken up in §10.

10. How *nyāya*, *dharma*, and *satya* are established in the process-dynamic

Nyāya, *dharma*, and *satya* name universal truths of coexistence: definite fulfilment in relationship, orderliness of innateness, and existence as coexistence. They are not human inventions added after the tetrad, and they are not absent from insentient nature. Every unit's *rūpa*, *guṇa*, *svabhāva*, and *dharma* already participate in those truths. What changes at sentience is not the truths but whether the unit has option with respect to them.

10.1 Default following and optional understanding

In insentient (*jada*) nature — the material and pranic orders — there is no option. Recognition and fulfilment are definite given constitution, distance, state, motion, and environment. Different mutualities yield different definite effects; no unit mis-evaluates what occurs (*The Ontology of Coexistence*, §1.3). The vector field F is constitutionally locked to complementary fulfilment. *Nyāya*, *dharma*, and *satya* are therefore already the dynamics: a mineral or a cell follows them by default as the law of its activity, not by judging just or unjust, resolved or unresolved, true or untrue. Conduct in the first three or-

ders is definite (JV, p. 113). Apart from humans, those orders are already mutually complementary (JV, p. 59).

The animal joint form is sentient, but its expression remains species-conformant. Selection and taste operate through a limited bodily medium without the human perspective-fork. Species-conformance keeps *F* definite; animal sentence does not introduce *nyāya–anyāya* as a live alternative.

The knowledge-order human has option. Knowing and believing may disconnect from recognition and fulfilment. Delusion identifies *jeevan* with the body and takes pleasant–unpleasant, healthy–unhealthy, and profit–loss as exhaustive refuge; humane living takes *nyāya–dharma–satya* as governing (MVD, p. 67). The same universal truths must then be followed through understanding. Behaviour is regulated through justice, thought through *dharma*, realisation through truth (MVD, p. 137) because those are the names under which the already-operative order is knowingly evidenced — not because *jada* lacked them.

Dharma as unit-innateness (*dhāraṇā*, Φ) is borne in every order. The *dharma–adharma* perspective appears only where there is option: thought can support resolution or fail it. *Nyāya* likewise names both the definite complementary fulfilment already present in *jada* couplings and, in the human, the completed activity of recognising relationships, fulfilling values, evaluating, and achieving mutual satisfaction (MVD, p. 311).

Niyam, *niyantran*, and *santulan* name law, regulation, and balance of activity in every order. In *jada* they are the definite activity-form of the same universal truths. They are not a second set of laws that humans later replace with *nyāya*, *dharma*, and *satya*. The widening sequence from knowledge through law to justice, *dharma*, and truth (MVD, p. 174) is how that one order becomes understood, not a term-by-term equation of *niyam* with *nyāya*.

10.2 How the four aspects are established

The tetrad is established as the definition of the unit, not as a later score. In the process-dynamic:

Aspect	What is established	In the dynamics
Form (<i>rūpa</i>)	The bounded configuration presently maintained	$x(t)$, the result already in place
Property (<i>guṇa</i>)	Relative power as generative, degenerative, or mediative effect	Directional modes of <i>F</i> in mutuality
Essential nature (<i>svabhāva</i>)	Order-specific characteristic conduct	Qualitative character of the same <i>F</i>
<i>Dharma</i> (innateness)	What the unit bears according to its order	Φ ; in the knowledge order evidenced as happiness

In *jada*, these four already run inside the universal truths: configuration, relative power, definite conduct, and innateness have no alternative branch. False learning is failure to understand a thing's form,

properties, essential nature, and *dharma* as they are (MVD, pp. 184, 263–264). Understanding does not create the aspects or the truths; it establishes them as known where option exists.

10.3 How *nyāya* is established

Justice is understood on the basis of relationships (JV, p. 120). In *jada*, relationship is definite complementarity: hungry and overfull, nourishment and composition, containment and organisation. *Nyāya* is established there by default as the closing of recognition and fulfilment in *F*. The mineral does not compute justice; its couplings already fulfil or fail as constitution, not as a chosen verdict.

In the human, the same truth must be established through understanding. Form is reflected and the relationship recognised; *guṇa* operates as fulfilment of the relationship's values, not as mere influence; *svabhāva* is the humane or inhumane character of that conduct; unit-*dharma* is evidenced as resolution and happiness when fulfilment holds.

The cycle can be stated as:

understanding of relationship → *recognition of value* → *conduct expressing svabhāva* →
evaluation → *mutual satisfaction*

Nyāya is established in the knowledge order when that cycle closes as mutual satisfaction. Option makes failure possible: causal effectiveness of *guṇa* does not establish justice; manipulation can influence another person while remaining unjust. Statutory law may or may not embody justice; legality alone does not close the cycle (*The Ontology of Coexistence*, §1.11–§1.12.1). The related reconstructions write the human closure as a behavioural verification constraint on *F*, and as recognition, fulfilment, and reflexive evaluation reaching mutual satisfaction (*A State-Dynamic Model of Coexistence*, §9; *Coexistence from First Principles*, §4.9). Reflexive evaluation can agree with or diverge from the definite mutuality already present. That divergence is the option; it is not available to *jada*.

10.4 How *dharma* is established

Unit-*dharma* is borne in every order as Φ . In *jada*, existence and growth orient *F* without an *adharma* alternative. The cell does not choose decline as a perspective; excited-state motion can displace it under pressure, but that is disturbance of definite conduct, not optional evaluation.

Where there is option, thought is disciplined through *dharma* (MVD, p. 137), understood on the basis of orderliness (JV, p. 120). Evaluative *dharma* is the alignment of the knowledge-order potential: whether $\Phi_{\text{cognitive}}$ orients *F* toward resolution rather than toward unresolved sensory, bodily, or material refuge. Inner friction — cognitive motion that cannot rest in understanding — is the failure of this alignment, not a second definition of unit-*dharma* (*A State-Dynamic Model of Coexistence*, §7.1, §8.1). Evaluative *dharma* is established when thought is resolved: knowing, believing, recognising, and fulfilling no longer contradict one another, and human *dharma* as happiness is evidenced. Activity completeness (T2) is restfulness of effort in that sense, not the vanishing of the unit.

10.5 How *satya* is established

Satya is understood on the basis of existence (JV, p. 120). In *jada*, existence as coexistence is already how the unit is: saturated, bounded, and active in definite mutuality. Truth is followed by default as the actuality of that coexistence; the unit does not verify or deny it.

Realisation takes place through truth (MVD, p. 137) because the human can take *asatya* as refuge. The *satya*–*asatya* perspective asks whether understanding accords with coexistence as it is. A motion may succeed as *guṇa*, express a plausible *svabhāva*, and even produce temporary mutual agreement, and still fail *satya* if the understanding from which *F* was selected does not accord with existence. *Satya* is established in the knowledge order when realisation knows coexistence, knows *jeevan* as the knower, and projects that knowing as authenticity in conduct. Truth in the widening sequence is realised as coexistence; realisation in coexistence is bliss (MVD, p. 174; *The Ontology of Coexistence*, §1.13).

10.6 One picture: same truths, two modes

Term	Universal content	In <i>jada</i> (no option)	In human sentence (option)
<i>Rūpa</i> , <i>guṇa</i> , <i>svabhāva</i> , unit- <i>dharma</i>	The unit as activity-whole	x , F , Φ locked to definite conduct	Same tetrad; F can be selected from understanding or from delusion
<i>Niyam</i> , <i>niyantran</i> , <i>santulan</i>	Law, regulation, and balance of activity	Definite conformance of F	Must be understood and kept; otherwise procedure replaces law
<i>Nyāya</i>	Definite fulfilment in relationship	Followed by default as complementary closing of F	Established through understanding as mutual satisfaction; <i>anyāya</i> is a live alternative
<i>Dharma</i>	Orderliness of innateness	Φ orients F with no <i>adharma</i> fork	Unit- <i>dharma</i> still borne; evaluative <i>dharma</i> is resolved thought
<i>Satya</i>	Existence as coexistence	Already the actuality of saturated unithood	Must be realised; <i>asatya</i> is a live alternative

Sustaining and balancing belong most directly to the mediative mode of *guṇa* and to *santulan* in activity. In *jada* that is already *nyāya* as default fulfilment. Human relationship-fulfilment additionally requires understanding, because option can break the cycle. It is consequently too narrow to define *svabhāva* universally as “what sustains a relationship,” and too narrow to treat *nyāya* or *satya* as human-only coordinates of x .

11. Limits of the process interpretation

A process-oriented reading is consistent with the primary texts under seven constraints.

First, “process” must mean persistent organised activity, not a momentary event. Units retain definite boundaries, constitutions, and identifiable continuity while remaining active.

Second, the four aspects must not be treated as chronological stages. Effort, motion, and result are inseparable in every activity; correspondingly, *rūpa*, *guṇa*, *svabhāva*, and *dharma* are co-present aspects of the unit.

Third, relational manifestation must not be confused with observer-construction. Form is reflected, property exerts influence, essential nature is recognised, and *dharma* is evidenced — and in the knowledge order evaluated as resolution — in mutuality; none is invented by the observer.

Fourth, the unit must not be reduced to its current relations. Madhyasth Darshan is process-compatible but not relation-only. The bearer (*guṇī*), its boundary, its constitution, its “ness,” and its order-specific *dharma* remain real. “Activity-whole” is therefore more faithful than saying that the unit is nothing but a process.

Fifth, the four aspects of a containing unit must not be treated as a sum or replacement of the constituents’ four aspects. Mixture retains the participants’ conducts and supplies no further tetrad; compound, cell, and body each add a containing tetrad while the constituents remain of their order (§8).

Sixth, motion must not be rewritten as a Newtonian second rate of change. First-order locking of x and $\dot{x}$ is the reconstruction of the triad’s joint form; inertial acceleration is not a further aspect, and Φ is not a global sum of *dharma*s (§9).

Seventh, *nyāya*, *dharma*, and *satya* must not be treated as human-only coordinates, and they must not be treated as optional in *jada*. They are universal truths of the dynamic: followed by default, with no option, in insentient units, and followed through understanding where sentience has option. Unit-*dharma* must not be collapsed into the *dharma*–*adharma* perspective; that perspective appears only with option (§10).

12. Compact formulation

Rūpa is how the unit is configured and bounded: shape, volume, and density.

Guṇa is how its power operates and affects mutuality.

Svabhāva is what characteristic, order-specific conduct that operation expresses.

Dharma is the innateness the unit bears (dhāraṇā); in the knowledge order this is evidenced as happiness and evaluated as resolution.

The four can be compressed into one sentence without collapsing their differences:

A unit is a bounded activity-whole whose configuration is rūpa, whose relative causal efficacy is guṇa, whose characteristic functional conduct is svabhāva, and whose order-specific innateness is dharma.

When the unit is a compound or a further organisation, that sentence applies twice: to each constituent, and to the containing unit as a further bounded activity-whole.

In process-dynamic terms: the present configuration is *rūpa*, the order-typed potential is *dharma*, and the motion by which the unit continues is *guṇa* characterised as *svabhāva*, written $\dot{x} = F(x, x_N; \Phi)$. *Nyāya*, *dharma*, and *satya* are universal truths of that motion: in *jada* they are followed by default as definite *F*; in human sentience they are established through understanding, because option can take *anyāya*, *adharma*, or *asatya* as refuge.

References

Madhyasth Darshan primary texts

- **MVD** — Nagraj, A. [Madhyasth Darshan — Co-existentialism](#). English translation by Rakesh Gupta. Cited: definitions of the four aspects (p. 47); form and the *sam-viṣam-madhyastha* distinction (pp. 50–51); order-specific *svabhāva* and *dharma* (pp. 50–51, 115); mediative regulation (p. 26); atomic constitution, mixture (*mishran*), and compound (*yaugik*) (p. 42); inhumane essential nature (p. 58); conduct as expression of essentiality (p. 77); humane and inhumane perspectives (p. 67); behaviour, thought, and realisation (p. 137); the sequence from knowledge through law to justice, *dharma*, and truth (p. 174); false learning as failure to understand the four aspects (pp. 184, 263–264); justice as relationship, fulfilment, evaluation, and mutual satisfaction (p. 311).
- **SB** — Nagraj, A. [Samadhanatmak Bhautikvad \(Resolution Centred Materialism\)](#). English translation by Rakesh Gupta. Cited: effort–motion–result and state–motion (pp. 58–62); change of form and properties with development (p. 55); composition is not development (pp. 75–76); order-specific *dharma* and the body/*jeevan* split (pp. 179–180); force, power, form, reflection, influence, recognition, and evaluation (pp. 248–252); bearer and property (pp. 256–257); a composition remains of the order of its constituents (p. 260).
- **JV** — Nagraj, A. [Jeevan Vidya: An Introduction](#). English translation by Rakesh Gupta. Cited: first three orders already complementary (p. 59); peepal-tree illustration of the four aspects, and definite conduct in those orders (p. 113); justice on the basis of relationships, *dharma* on the basis of orderliness, truth on the basis of existence (p. 120).

Related studies

- [The Ontology of Coexistence](#), especially §1.3 (definite insentient mutuality), §1.10, “Composition and assemblies,” and §1.11–§1.13 (regulation, evaluative perspectives, justice, and realisation).

- [*A State-Dynamic Model of Coexistence*](#), especially §2–§3 (state, derivative, and potential), §4.3 (nested compositional plateaus), §5.4 (the tetrad of a containing unit), and §7–§9 (delusion, completeness, and verification).
- [*The Epistemology of Coexistence*](#), especially §1.4 on the six perspectives and on *niyam–niyantran–santulan* with *nyāya–dharma–satya*.
- [*Coexistence from First Principles*](#), especially §4.9 on reflexive evaluation and justice as mutual satisfaction.